

Ideation and Problem Definition

Cooking Planner App

Members

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End User

University students who live off campus or without a meal plan or adults who are learning to cook for themselves / people who need to plan their meals and manage grocery shopping on a fixed budget.

Problem Definition

Many people who are new to cooking often find it tedious because of how hard it can be to stay organized. Their recipes tend to be split between browser tabs, social media posts, and screenshots, which makes it difficult to work out a meal plan for the week. This often leads to people buying more groceries than they need, which end up going to waste, or eating out more than they can afford to. An app that combines all of these aspects, allowing users to plan their meals and have the recipes on-hand, would help reduce both food waste and over-budget spending.

Ideation Methodology

Our group used the Divergent Round Robin method to brainstorm ideas. Each member individually contributed an idea, which helped us come up with several options with a wide variety of use-cases to choose from. After putting together everyone's suggestions, we decided on a problem statement which felt both unique and relatable.

Ideas/Most Voted Idea

1. **Smart Study Planner:** An app to keep track of deadlines and study time, which would allow students to log their classes, due dates, and study hours.
2. **Campus Navigation & Transit App:** An app to help students navigate the UNT campus, which would allow users to track live bus routes, find building locations, and view real-time arrival times for campus shuttles.
3. **Personal Finance Tracker:** An app to keep track and monitor spending/savings. Keep track of subscriptions and other recurring payments to help budget and manage money.
4. **Cooking Planner App:** An app that lets users save recipes from multiple sources to one place, plan weekly meals in a calendar, and generate a grocery shopping list based on the planned meals.

The most voted app was the Cooking Planner App due to its broader target demographic, which extends beyond only university students. Instead of addressing a campus-specific issue, this app could be used by students, families, and adults living alone, since issues with scattered recipes and meal planning are nearly universal. It would make the chaotic process of finding recipes, planning, and actually cooking those meals into something much simpler and more straightforward.